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Wreath, crown

6.8 Wreath, crown

References:

Hebrew לִוְיָה (liwyah) PRO 1:9, PRO 4:9

Hebrew צְפִירָה (tsefirah) ISA 28:5

Greek κισσός (kissos) 2MA 6:7

Greek στεφανηφορέω (stefanēforeō (verb)) WIS 4:2

Greek στέφανος, στεφανόω (stefanos, stefanoō (verb)) 1CO 9:25, PHP 4:1, 1TH 2:19, 2TI 2:5, 2TI 4:8, JAS 1:12, 1PE 5:4, REV 2:10, REV 3:11, JDT 15:13, JDT 3:7, JDT 15:13, ESG 8:15, SIR 1:11, SIR 1:18, SIR 6:31, SIR 15:6, SIR 25:6, SIR 32:2, SIR 45:12, SIR 50:12, LJE 1:8, 1MA 1:22, 1MA 4:57, 1MA 10:20, 3MA 3:28, 4MA 17:15, PSS 8:17

Greek στέφος (stefos) 3MA 4:8

Greek στέφω (stefō (verb)) WIS 2:8

Latin corona 2ES 2:43, 2ES 2:46

Latin corono (verb) 2ES 2:45

Description and usage:

Man wearing wreath (Public Domain Wikimedia Commons)The wreath was a ring consisting either of foliage or of precious metals formed to resemble foliage and worn around the top of the head as a symbol of honor or victory, or as a badge of high office. For the crown of royalty, see 1.10.2 Crown<REALIA:1.10.2>.

Translation:

It may be important in some contexts to indicate clearly the significance of the wreath worn on the head, for example, "wreath to show victory." To describe "a wreath" merely as "a circle of leaves" would hardly be sufficient to indicate its cultural significance. In order to do justice to the cultural relevance of such a wreath, it may be important to add some type of marginal note.

In some languages the term "crown" suggests only a symbol of ruling rather than a symbol of reward as the result of being victorious. It may therefore be better in some passages to translate "crown" as "prize" or "reward"; for example, for the literal clause "he will receive the crown of life" (RSV) in JAS 1:12 (which has no implications of royalty), CEV has "He will reward you with a glorious life."

PHP 4:1: Here Paul refers to the Philippians as "my crown." In some languages translators may be able to preserve this figurative expression by saying "you are like a crown for my head." But sometimes this type of rendering has resulted in wrong meanings; for example, it has been understood in the sense of "you are a weight upon my head," and thus a mental burden. Other possible renderings are "how proud I am of you!" (GNT), "I am always glad to tell people about you," and "I am always boasting about you." For the literal expression "my joy and crown," CEV has found a closely parallel English idiom with "You are my pride and joy."